

Veer Sanyal

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Dear Ms. Pedley:

I am writing to apply for the Summer 2026 Purdue Daniels Externship. I am a sophomore in the Mitch Daniels School of Business pursuing a B.S. in Integrated Business and Engineering, graduating in May 2028. The structure of this externship—four weeks, a real client, a small student team working asynchronously to diagnose a problem and deliver a proposal—mirrors the kind of work I have actively sought out across SMIF, an internship at an early-stage company, and EPICS. I would bring structured industry and competitor research, hands-on experience presenting analysis to stakeholders, and a track record of cross-functional execution under tight timelines.

The closest parallel in my experience is my work as an Equity Research Analyst at Purdue's Student Managed Investment Fund. Over the past year, I researched U.S. Bancorp end-to-end—competitive landscape, customer trends, revenue drivers, and downside risks—and built a 3-statement model in Excel to quantify the thesis under multiple scenarios. I co-authored a 20-page report and presented a 10-slide proposal to a 30+ member investment committee, defending assumptions in live Q&A and incorporating feedback into the final recommendation. The arc—understand the business, study the industry, identify what is and is not working, and translate that into a recommendation a non-expert audience can act on—is exactly what Weeks 2 through 4 of the externship ask student teams to do for a small business client.

I have also done this kind of work in a fully remote, cross-functional setting. As a Product and Engineering Intern at Firmly, an early-stage e-commerce platform, I worked across product, engineering, and support teams—all distributed across time zones—to diagnose a recurring PayPal checkout failure. I mapped roughly 15 edge-case scenarios with the team, proposed a guided recovery flow to replace a generic error page, and authored handoff documentation that aligned everyone on expected behavior. I also built a repeatable QA workflow that the team adopted as its standard, which is the part of the engagement I am most proud of: leaving a small organization with a process improvement that outlasted my time there. That same instinct—deliver something the client can actually use after the engagement ends—is what I would bring to the externship's final proposal.

Finally, I have practiced leading small teams toward stakeholder-facing milestones. As Communications Officer and Build Lead on a 7-person EPICS team this past fall, I coordinated weekly task assignments, surfaced blockers, and presented design tradeoffs to faculty, sponsors, and museum stakeholders in two formal reviews. The experience taught me how to keep a team aligned when members come from different majors and bring different working styles—directly relevant to the externship's emphasis on the NACE competencies of teamwork, communication, and professionalism.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to a Daniels student team this summer and to learn directly from a small business client. I can be reached at 360-643-9424 or vsanyal@purdue.edu.

Sincerely,
Veer Sanyal